

B2 First for Schools Reading and Use of English Part 3

Aims of the lesson	- to familiarise students with what is required in Part 3 of the Reading and Use of English Paper: Word-building or Word Formation - to give student strategies for completing Part 3
Time needed	50 minutes
Materials required	- Student's worksheet (one copy for each student) - Sample task (one per student) - Answer sheet (copy for each student from the relevant pages of the Reading and Use of English section of the B2 First for Schools Handbook)

Procedure

- Write the word '*know*' on the board and write the table as below only leave it empty. Ask the students to put the word *know* into the table and put it in the verb column. Brainstorm another word which can be formed from '*know*' and put this in the table as well. In pairs or small groups, give them two minutes to brainstorm all the other words formed from '*know*' for this. When you see they have finished, write the words they have come up with on the board, putting them into the table:

verb	noun	adjective (can you add a prefix or a suffix?)	adverb (can you add a prefix or a suffix?)
know knew known knowing	knowledge	knowing unknowing known unknown knowledgeable knowable unknowable	knowingly unknowingly knowledgeably

2. Explain that you are going to look at Part 3 of the Reading and Use of English paper, in which their ability to build words is tested.
3. Write the title '**Skyscraper? No, 'water-scraper!'**' on the board and ask the class what they think the text will be about.
4. Give out the **Sample task** and ask the students to read the text quickly to see if any of their predictions were correct. They should ignore the gaps in the text for now. Allow about 3 minutes for this, then elicit what the text is about and if they were correct (*it's about a very tall building built on the seabed – it doesn't exist, but it's a possible idea for buildings of the future*).
5. Elicit what candidates have to do to complete this task. Focus on the words in capitals at the end of some of the lines (tell the students that these are called *stem words*), and using the example, establish that they need to form a new word using these stem words to complete the gaps. Look at the example (*competition*), ask them what part of speech it is (look at the table for 'know' you have just done to give them alternatives if they aren't sure), and elicit that this is a noun. Go through the text with the whole class, eliciting which part of speech each gap could be filled with (see Sample Task **Answer key**, table second column). Deciding what word class is needed in each of the gaps is also a very important strategy, which students should practise regularly.
6. Divide the students into two groups. Ask each group to line up in alphabetical order, using first names only.
7. Give the board pen to the first person in the class alphabetically (if both groups are headed by someone with the same name, toss a coin!)
8. The first person comes to the board and writes the word they (and their group, who can help) think is correct for the first gap. If it's correct, the next person in the same group can come to the board and write the next word. If they make a mistake, the board pen passes to the other group. Mark the words so each group can keep a tally of their correct answers. The winning group is the one with the most correct words.
9. Look at the correct answers on the board with the class. Elicit how the stem word has been changed (see **Answer key**). Tell the students that some answers are possible by reading just a word or two before or after the gap. For example, '*competition*': it is clear that a noun is required from the word 'a' earlier in the sentence. However, there are other answers where the whole paragraph is needed. This is especially true where negative prefixes are required, as in the example '*impossible*' here. Reading the whole text through before trying to complete any of the gaps is a very useful strategy for this task. Candidates should always bear in mind the meaning of the text as a whole as well as the language on either side of each gap.

10. Give out the Student's worksheet and ask students to work in pairs/ small groups to decide if the sentences about B2 First for Schools Reading and Use of English Part 3 are true or false. If they think a sentence is false, they should try to correct it.
11. Feed back with the whole class, eliciting corrections to the false sentences and encouraging students to write down the corrections (see Key).
12. Give students an Answer sheet each so they can see where they will record their answers.
13. Finally ask the students to look at the example text and to tell you which part of speech hasn't been addressed. The answer is adverbs. Tell them that this is a very common question as in the sentence: 'He didn't care about his appearance and dressed_____'. Give the class stem word TIDY. This is a good example of a more difficult question as it requires changes at both ends. Elicit the answer 'untidily'. Tell the students to look in their coursebooks and find an example of an adverb in a word building.

Suggested follow-up activity

- Give students words and ask them to think of words they can form from them. If dictionaries are available, these could be used to check answers, but remind students that they won't be able to use dictionaries in the exam. E.g.

- belief (believe, disbelieve, believable, unbelievable, believing, disbelieving, unbelieving, believer, unbeliever...)
- beauty (beautiful, beautify, beautification, beauties...)
- deep (depth, deepen, deeper, deepest...)

Feedback in this case can be as a game of tennis. If the class is in two groups, the team serves with their first word, for example 'believe', the second group returns with for example 'believable', the first group gives another word, for example 'disbelief'. The winner of the point is the team with the most answers, so the rally continues until one team has no more words. The serve for the next stem word goes to the next team. To gather stem words simply look through some past paper part 3's, you will soon see that there are words which very regularly come up.

- Practise recognising words in texts, songs, etc which are formed from a stem word, and also recognising what word class these words are.
- Ask students to find words from which lots of other words can be formed – they could bring them in to challenge their classmates in a future class.

Answer key

Student's worksheet

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. There are ten gaps to fill. | FALSE (<i>there are eight gaps</i>) |
| 2. You can only write one word in each gap. | TRUE |
| 3. The gaps are on different lines from the stem words. | FALSE (<i>always on the same line</i>) |
| 4. Part 3 covers mostly grammar but vocabulary is also involved. | FALSE (<i>mostly vocabulary, but grammar is also involved</i>) |
| 5. Sometimes you have to read beyond the sentence to get the answer. | TRUE |
| 6. There are 2 marks for each correct answer. | FALSE (<i>1 mark</i>) |
| 7. Minor spelling mistakes are permitted. | FALSE (<i>correct spelling is essential</i>) |
| 8. Answers must be written on a separate answer sheet in capital letters. | TRUE |
| 9. Words can be negatives or plurals of the given stem word. | TRUE |
| 10. Some stem words remain the same. | FALSE (<i>all stem words must be changed</i>) |

Sample task

	Key	Word class (part of speech) required	Change required
17.	impressive	Adjective	verb changed to adjective
18.	responded	Verb	noun changed to verb
19.	height	adjective	adjective changed to noun
20.	agricultural	adjective	noun changed to adjective
21.	movement(s)	Noun	verb changed to noun
22.	impossible	adjective	adjective changed to adjective
23.	populations	Noun	verb changed to noun
24.	reality	Noun	adjective changed to noun

Student's worksheet

Decide whether the following sentences about Part 3 of the Reading and Use of English paper are TRUE or FALSE. Correct the sentences which are wrong.

1. There are ten gaps to fill.
2. You can only write one word in each gap.
3. The gaps are on different lines from the stem words.
4. Part 3 covers mostly grammar but vocabulary is also involved.
5. Sometimes you have to read beyond the sentence to get the answer.
6. There are 2 marks for each correct answer.
7. Minor spelling mistakes are permitted.
8. Answers must be written on a separate answer sheet in capital letters.
9. Words can be negatives or plurals of the given stem word.
10. Some stem words remain the same.

Sample task

For questions **17 – 24**, read the text below. Use the word given in capitals at the end of some of the lines to form a word that fits in the gap **in the same line**. There is an example at the beginning **(0)**.

Write your answers **IN CAPITAL LETTERS** on the **separate answer sheet**.

Example:

0	C	O	M	P	E	T	I	T	I	O	N						
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	--	--	--	--	--	--

Skyscraper? No, 'water-scraper'!

Each year, EV Magazine hosts a skyscraper design **(0)** Most entrants imagine giant buildings taller than anything under construction today. However, the most **(17)** entry this year went the opposite route. Malaysian designer, Sarly Adre bin Sarkum, **(18)** to the need for a different kind of development by dropping his building straight downwards into the sea. He deliberately designed it to contrast with the skyscrapers that dominate the competition, and to highlight sustainable architecture.

COMPETE

His self-sufficient 'water-scraper' would be similar in **(19)** to the Empire State Building, but with only a couple of storeys above the sea's surface. Wind, solar, and wave power would provide energy and a green space containing forests and **(20)** areas at the top would provide food and oxygen. Living and work areas would be below the sea's surface. The structure would be kept level by giant tentacles. The tentacles would also generate electricity through ocean **(21)**

IMPRESS

RESPONSE

HIGH

AGRICULTURE

MOVE

No-one is building anything like this now but it is **(22)** to be certain of what our future housing needs will be. Land will become scarcer as **(23)** grow and, since approximately 71% of the Earth's surface is ocean, cities in the sea may one day be a **(24)**

POSSIBLE

POPULATE

REAL